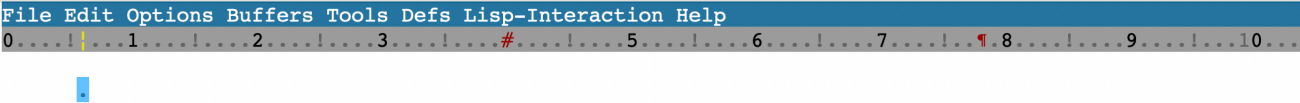


Filling and Justification

Description	Keystroke	Function	Note
Filling, Justification, Position (and navigation) Information ◦ Filling Text ◦ Text Justification • Center text horizontally	Under some conditions, and for editing some type of files, it may be useful to see the horizontal ruler above the window of a buffer. - The ruler-mode provides this functionality. - You can also use a vertical line highlighting a specific column: see ↗ Highlight Emacs filling uses several variables identifying the column where text must wrap. The main variable is the fill-column variable. But it's not the only one. - For buffer used to show and edit Lisp or Emacs Lisp code, the emacs-lisp-docstring-fill-column controls text wrapping inside Lisp docstrings. - The values of the relevant fill wrapping controlling column is shown by the pel-show-fill-column command, shown below.		
Last updated on:	2026-09-19		
Open this PDF file. See also: ↗ Help/Info	<f11> t f <f1> <f11> t j <f1>	(pel-help-pdf &optional OPEN-WEB-PAGE)	Open the ↗ Filling/Justification local PDF. With C-u , M-- , M- -1 or C- -1 prefix: open the remote GitHub hosted PDF instead. If the pel-flip-help-pdf-arg user-option is set it's the other way around.
Customize Emacs file and justification control See also: ↗ Customize	<f11> t f <f3> <f11> t j <f3>	(pel-customize-library &optional OTHER-WINDOW)	Customize Emacs fill and justification control.
Show the ruler See also: ↗ Highlight	<f11> b -	(ruler-mode &optional ARG)	Toggle display of ruler in header line (Ruler mode) in window(s) of current buffer. With a prefix argument, enable Ruler mode if ARG is positive, disable it otherwise.
Example of the ruler in terminal mode showing the ruler-mode markers ➡➡ ... and the point (cursor) ➡➡	- The ruler markers are: Current cursor position ! Marks every 5 positions. # Current <i>comment-column</i> value, set by C-x ; It controls where the cursor goes when creating a new comment on a line. ¶ Current <i>fill-column</i> value, set by C-x f, controls where the cursor wraps. G Current <i>goal-column</i> value, controlled by C-x C-n. The horizontal position when going up and down lines via C-p and C-n. If nil, its G symbol will not show on the ruler and it will not have any impact on the navigation commands. See the information about the set-goal-column command in the navigation table.		
			
Show the values of the fill columns	<f11> t f ?	(pel-show-fill-columns)	Display values of relevant user-options and variables controlling text fill and justification inside a special "pel-fill-info" buffer. In that buffer the user-options and variable names are buttons providing access to more information.
Toggle ruler line on fill column See also: • ↗ Highlight • ↗ Spell Checking	<f11> h \ <f11> <f5> \ <f11> 8	(fci-mode &optional ARG)	Toggle a vertical ruler line shown at the buffer's fill-column. - For Emacs < 27.1:  requires the fill-column-indicator external package  activated by PEL use-fill-column-indicator user option set to t.  fci-mode interferes with pop-up menu displays in terminal-mode, at least with the one used by flyspell-correct-word-before-point: the menu lines become all jagged, they do not line up vertically. The problem does not affect Emacs running in graphics mode. - For Emacs >= 27.1: the built-in display-fill-column-indicator-mode is used.
Filling Text See also: ↗ Text Modes	- For fill and refill mode to work properly on text: - Sentences must be separated by 2 spaces (unless <i>sentence-end-double-space</i> is t): use <f11> t m s to change this. - Paragraphs must be separated by 1 empty line. - Identify major modes where the auto-fill-mode is automatically activated in the pel-modes-activating-auto-fill-mode user-option. - Access the relevant customization buffer with <f11> t <f2>		
Toggle end of sentence space count	<f11> t m s	(pel-toggle-sentence-end)	Toggle the value of sentence-end-double-space variable to change the number of required spaces after a period to identify at the end of a sentence in text: from 2 (the default) to 1 and vice-versa.
Set Fill Column	C-x f <f11> t f c	(set-fill-column ARG)	When no prefix value: prompts for column. If with C-u prefix: use current column. If with numeric prefix value: use that value.
Toggle auto-fill mode	<f11> t f C <f11> RET	(auto-fill-mode &optional ARG)	Toggle automatic line breaking (Auto Fill mode). - With prefix argument, enable Auto Fill mode if prefix argument is positive, and disable it otherwise. - When Auto Fill mode is enabled, inserting a space at a column beyond 'current-fill-column' automatically breaks the line at a previous space.
Toggle auto-fill inside comments only	<f11> t f ;	(pel-auto-fill-only-comments)	Toggle the <i>comment-auto-fill-only-comments</i> variable to control whether filling is done everywhere or only inside the comments.
Toggle refill mode	<f11> t f f	(refill-mode &optional ARG)	Toggle automatic refilling (Refill mode). - With a prefix argument ARG, enable Refill mode if ARG is positive, and disable it otherwise. - Refill mode is a buffer-local minor mode. When enabled, the current paragraph is refilled as you edit. Self-inserting characters only cause refilling if they would cause auto-filling.
Set fill prefix	C-x . <f11> t f .	(set-fill-prefix)	Set the fill prefix to the current line up to point. - Filling expects lines to start with the fill prefix and reinserts the fill prefix in each resulting line. - The fill prefix is then inserted before any character typed in the line.
Fill region	<f11> t f r	(fill-region FROM TO &optional JUSTIFY NOSQUEEZE TO-EOP)	Fill each of the paragraphs in the region. The 'fill-column' variable controls the width. A prefix arg means justify as well.
Fill region as one paragraph	<f11> t f q	(fill-region-as-paragraph FROM TO &optional JUSTIFY NOSQUEEZE SQUEEZE-AFTER)	Fill the region as one paragraph. - It removes any paragraph breaks in the region and extra newlines at the end, indents and fills lines between the margins given by the 'current-left-margin' and 'current-fill-column' functions. - In most cases, the variable 'fill-column' controls the width. - It leaves point at the beginning of the line following the paragraph. - Normally performs justification according to the 'current-justification' function, but with a prefix arg, does full justification instead. - If 'sentence-end-double-space' is non-nil, then period followed by one space does not end a sentence, so don't break a line there. You can change this using the (pel-toggle-sentence-end) bound to <f11> t m s.
Fill current paragraph  Refill also properly refill a multi-line comment and strings.	M-q <f11> t f p	(fill-paragraph &optional JUSTIFY REGION)	Fill paragraph at or after point. To justify as well: C-u M-q - In refill mode, refill is done automatically. In auto-fill mode, it's done on reaching fill column. - The M-q key is also used in major modes for programming languages but is mapped to a different command for several of them.
Fill Lisp code section	<f11> t f l	(lisp-fill-paragraph &optional JUSTIFY)	Like M-q , but handle Emacs Lisp comments and docstrings. - If any of the current line is a comment, fill the comment or the paragraph of it that point is in, preserving the comment's indentation and initial semicolons. - Temporarily binds 'fill-column' to 'emacs-lisp-docstring-fill-column' which is used to identify the fill column for Emacs Lisp docstring.
Fill region, each indentation starts a new "paragraph"	<f11> t f i	(fill-individual-paragraphs MIN MAX &optional JUSTIFY CITATION-REGEXP)	Fill paragraphs of uniform indentation within the region. This command divides the region into "paragraphs", treating every change in indentation level or prefix as a paragraph boundary, then fills each paragraph using its indentation level as the fill prefix.
Fill region considering only paragraph-separator lines as starting a new paragraph	<f11> t f n	(fill-nonuniform-paragraphs MIN MAX &optional JUSTIFYP CITATION-REGEXP)	Fill paragraphs within the region, allowing varying indentation within each. This command divides the region into "paragraphs", only at paragraph-separator lines, then fills each paragraph using as the fill prefix the smallest indentation of any line in the paragraph.

Description	Keystroke	Function	Note
Text Justification See also:  Enriched Text	Text justification is normally used when enriched text support is activated via the enriched-mode. The standard Emacs key- sequences listed below are only available in enriched-mode. The PEL key-sequences are always available.		
Toggle Enriched Text Mode See also:  Text Modes	<f11> t e e <f11> t m e	(enriched-mode &optional ARG)	Minor mode for editing text/enriched files. These are files with embedded formatting information in the MIME standard text/enriched format.
Set justification - full (both)	M-j b	(set-justification-full B E)	Make paragraphs in the region fully justified. - This makes lines flush on both margins by inserting spaces between words. - If the mark is not active, this applies to the current paragraph.
	<f11> t j f		
Set justification - left	M-j l	(set-justification-left B E)	Make paragraphs in the region left-justified. - This means they are flush at the left margin and ragged on the right. - If the mark is not active, this applies to the current paragraph.
	<f11> t j l		
Set justification - center	M-j c M-S	(set-justification-center B E)	Make paragraphs in the region centered. If the mark is not active, this applies to the current paragraph.
	<f11> t j c		
Set justification - right	M-j r	(set-justification-right B E)	Make paragraphs in the region right-justified. - This means they are flush at the right margin and ragged on the left. - If the mark is not active, this applies to the current paragraph.
	<f11> t j r		
Set justification - none (un-justify)	M-j u	(set-justification-none B E)	Disable automatic filling for paragraphs in the region. If the mark is not active, this applies to the current paragraph.
	<f11> t j u		
Centering	The following commands center text horizontally.		
Center paragraph	M-o M-S	(center-paragraph)	Center each nonblank line in the paragraph at or after point.
Center line	M-o M-s	(center-line &optional NLINES)	Center the line point is on, within the width specified by ‘fill-column’. - It adjusts the indentation so that it equals the distance between the end of the text and ‘fill-column’. - With numeric prefix argument NLINES: centres that many lines.  The ⌘-- key is normally bound here in graphics mode. PEL re-assigns it.

Filling and Justification — References

Operation	Keystroke
Text Filling	
GNU Emacs Lisp - Text - Filling	
GNU Emacs Lisp - Text - Auto Filling	
GNU Emacs Lisp - Text - Adaptive Filling	
GNU Emacs Lisp - Text - Margins	
Emacs hard wrap lines	
Emacs wiki - Ruler Mode	
Emacs wiki - refilling mode	
Emacs wiki - Auto Fill Mode	
How to set multiline comments - StackOverflow	
Line Wraps	
Truncate Lines @ EmacsWiki	Describes how to set/disable line wrapping globally. Also explains how to control it for a given mode.
Line Wrap @ EmacsWiki	Describes various modes: AutoFillMode, LongLines, VisualLineMode
longlines-mode @ emacs horror	Discuss difference between longlines-mode and visual-line-mode
ErgoEmacs: Show Cursor Position	Xah Lee's ErgoEmacs web site has a picture of the ruler at the top of this page. I did not see one inside Emacs manuals (yet, let me know if you find one).